be humanly impossible to come to agreement on all issues unless you and I are in the same place for several weeks, or unless you and Bohr and associates are in the same place for several weeks, or both." Wheeler went on to say to Everett that he was "sure that [your work] will receive discussion of a scope comparable to what has attended Bohm's publications," a backhanded compliment at best. Unsurprisingly, later in the same letter, Wheeler felt the need to assure Everett that he was his "'promoter,' and one actively interested in your reputation and promising future."

Despite Wheeler's insistence that Everett go to Copenhagen immediately, Everett didn't go. Part of the reason was a message from Petersen, informing Everett that Bohr was out of town until the fall—and that Bohr and his circle wanted Everett to do more work before he visited. "I think it would be very helpful to us if, as a background of your criticism, you gave a thorough treatment of the attitude behind the complementary mode of description [i.e., the Copenhagen interpretation] and as clearly as possible stated the points where you think that this approach is insufficient." "While I am doing [that], you might do the same for my work," Everett shot back. "I believe that a number of misunderstandings will evaporate when it has been read more carefully (say 2 or 3 times)." Nonetheless, Everett still wanted to go to Copenhagen, but the schedule Petersen proposed was another problem; Everett was supposed to start a new job at the Weapons Systems Evaluation Group (WSEG) at the Pentagon in less than a month, designing war games and doing operations research on nuclear strikes for the military. Spending time on a detailed reply to Rosenfeld and Bohr, in addition to the new work Wheeler required of Everett for his thesis, all on top of the day-to-day work of his new job, was just not possible—nor was a two-month-long trip to Copenhagen in the fall (as Petersen had proposed) for work totally unrelated to WSEG.

Wheeler couldn't make Everett go to Copenhagen, but he could make him slave over revisions to his PhD thesis. When Wheeler returned to the United States at the end of the summer of 1956, that's exactly what happened. "Hugh and I worked long hours at night in my office to revise the draft," Wheeler recalled later. Wheeler told his friend and colleague Bryce DeWitt that "I sat down with Everett and told him what to say." Finally, six months later, Everett submitted the radically revised and